

Chapter 86-4

Before lying in bed, Liang Shi was still wondering if she would have trouble sleeping in an unfamiliar bed¹.

But the moment she lay down, she knew she wouldn't.

This mattress was so soft—soft enough that she could bury her head in the blanket and fall asleep immediately.

It might also be because she had been exhausted these past two days.

Just as she was nestled in bed, drowsy and about to fall asleep, that familiar eerie electronic voice suddenly sounded in her mind:

【Ding dong! Congratulations to the Host for completing Side Mission 1: Go on a three-day, two-night trip with Xu Qingzhu. The mission reward is 3 Luck Points or 300,000 RMB. Please make your selection.】

【Also, a friendly reminder: After 80 Luck Points, the difficulty of accumulating Luck Points doubles. If you cannot trigger key information, it will be difficult to accumulate Luck Points to 100. Please choose your mission reward carefully. Within ten minutes of the Host's selection, the mission reward will be deposited into the Host's account.】

After hesitating, Liang Shi chose the 300,000 yuan.

There was still half the time left until the mission ended, so accumulating 20 Luck Points shouldn't be difficult.

Besides, the system had already reminded her during the last announcement that she had accumulated 87 Luck Points, so only 13 remained.

Under these circumstances, she decisively chose the money.

【Alright, the mission reward will be deposited into the Host's account within ten minutes. Please check for receipt!】

However...

"Did you make a calculation error? Strictly speaking, we didn't go on a three-day, two-night trip. At most, it was two days and two nights," Liang Shi asked hesitantly.

System: 【...】

The system's moment of silence made Liang Shi feel like the other party was cursing her for being an idiot.

After all, it had already announced completion—why did she have to expose the issue?

Liang Shi regretted it the second after she asked. Her mouth was just a bit faster than her brain.

Mainly because she had also thought about this mission on the way back from the suburbs. At the time, she felt it probably wouldn't be completed, and she was already planning the next trip in her mind.

A moment later, the System answered: 【I hate that you're such a blockhead!】

Liang Shi: "?"

If this were a person, Liang Shi could understand and accept it quite well.

But the other party was an AI—an emotionless AI!

The System still had that eerie mechanical voice, and when it said the word "blockhead," there was a sudden burst of static—crackling and sizzling.

It hurt to listen to and made the statement even less credible.

System: 【Is the important part of a three-day, two-night trip the three days? No! It's the two nights! During two romantic nights, you two snuggled together intimately, sitting by the bonfire, standing by the sea. What matters isn't where you are, but that there are two people! A more intimate space nurtures the little sparks of ambiguity between two people, so this mission counts as completed.】

Liang Shi: "But at home, it's also a two-person space."

System: 【...】

【Ding dong! Because the Host is too dense, Little Tong² will bestow upon the Host a new title: Romance Killer.】

Liang Shi: "?"

"Is this title useful?" Liang Shi asked.

System: 【It's convenient for me to mock you!】

Liang Shi: "..."

Get lost.

Liang Shi's head hurt. She had made a mistake and was now being mocked by an AI as a Romance Killer?

No, she refused to accept this.

But the System did something even more despicable.

A few seconds later, the System's mechanical voice sounded again: 【Since the Host pointed out that the mission was not fully completed, the reward for this mission has been changed to 200,000 yuan, distributed according to the actual time spent. The reward will be deposited into the Host's account within ten minutes. Please check for receipt.】

Liang Shi: "?"

System: 【Honesty is a virtue praised by all of humanity. We hope the Host continues to maintain this quality.】

Liang Shi: "..."

"So will you reward me for my honesty?" Liang Shi asked with a hint of despair.

The System answered with certainty: 【No, but we will praise you. Host, you're so awesome! This is the first time I've seen such an honest Host. It's truly moving! Thank you for considering the Grudge Management Bureau's financial situation. All the employees will be grateful to you.】

Liang Shi: "..."

She felt that sentence was equivalent to: This is the first time I've seen someone so stupid. You actually considered other people's budget issues while forgetting that you're still broke yourself.

Liang Shi sighed, regretting it immensely. She didn't want to talk to the System anymore.

System: 【Oh no! The Host has already started to dislike Little Tong, but Little Tong still wants to continue serving the Host. Ying ying ying³.】

Liang Shi: "..."

This System was still as chatty as ever.

System: 【What did Little Tong do wrong? I just wanted to talk a bit more with the Host. After all, the Host is completing missions so quickly and well—you'll probably reach 100 Luck Points soon. While I'm happy for the Host, Little Tong is also secretly grieving.】

Liang Shi couldn't take it anymore and said coldly, "Get to the point."

System: 【...】

【Ding dong ding dong! Congratulations to the Host for completing the bonus task of the hidden mission: Help Xu Qingzhu reunite with her parents! The bonus task reward is 500,000 yuan and will be deposited into the Host's account within ten minutes. Please check for receipt!】

【Little Tong has really turned into a sour lemon⁴! The Host's 3S-rank lucky constitution really lets you become a salted fish⁵ and win while lying down. I'd like to interview the Host—is it fun being a lucky salted fish?】

Liang Shi: "..."

It was indeed fun, but she wasn't going to say it.

This mission reward was basically a freebie, and she had received the full reward amount.

¹ **Trouble sleeping in an unfamiliar bed (認床, rèn chuáng):** A Chinese expression meaning to have difficulty sleeping when not in one's own bed. Some people are said to "recognize" only their own bed and have trouble falling asleep elsewhere.

² **Little Tong (小統, xiǎo tǒng):** The System's cute nickname for itself, derived from "系統" (xìtǒng, meaning "system"). It uses this name when speaking in a cutesy or whiny manner.

³ **Ying ying ying (嚶嚶嚶):** An onomatopoeia representing cute crying or whimpering sounds, often used in Chinese internet culture to express being pitiful or seeking sympathy in an exaggerated, cutesy way.

⁴ **Sour lemon (檸檬精, níngméng jīng):** Chinese internet slang meaning someone who is jealous or envious. Similar to saying "I'm so sour/jealous" in English. The term literally means "lemon spirit/essence."

⁵ **Salted fish (鹹魚, xián yú):** Chinese slang for someone who lies around doing nothing, lacking ambition or motivation—like a dead, preserved fish. "Lying down and winning" (躺贏) refers to achieving success without putting in effort.